

Research Assistant Mentoring Evaluations

Spring 2022 - Summer 2026

Evaluation overview

Evaluation period	Career stage	RAs mentored that semester	Evaluations	Approx. coverage
Spring 2022	Postbaccalaureate	5	2	40.0%
Fall 2022	PhD program; midsemester evaluation	9	6	66.7%
Spring 2023	PhD program	12	8	66.7%
Fall 2023	PhD program	8	7	87.5%
Spring 2024	PhD program	12	10	83.3%
Fall 2024	PhD program	14	10	71.4%
Spring 2025	PhD program	18	11	61.1%
Spring 2026	PhD program	16	7	43.8%
Summer 2026	PhD program	10	6	60.0%

Comparable ratings across evaluation periods

Mentoring measure	N	Mean	Favorable (4-5)
Mentor knowledgeable	51	4.98	100.0%
Mentor enthusiastic	51	4.92	100.0%
Mentor prepared	17	4.94	100.0%
Experiment-session instructions clear	50	4.68	98.0%
Overall mentor rating	51	4.92	100.0%
Overall research experience	67	4.79	97.0%
Experience met expectations	67	4.76	95.5%

Across 67 completed evaluations, research assistants consistently rated the mentoring relationship and research experience positively. Written feedback emphasizes clear and supportive guidance, practical research learning, increased confidence, and professional development. Recurring suggestions include more exposure to data analysis, refresher training, early team-building, and clearer expectations for quality checks and independent project work.

Spring 2022

Postbaccalaureate. Research assistants mentored: 5. Completed evaluations: 2 (40.0% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Overall research experience	5.00
Experience met expectations	5.00

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
How useful were the weekly lab meetings?	2	4.50	1–5 scale
How useful were the assigned articles?	2	4.00	1–5 scale
How useful was the articles discussion?	2	4.50	1–5 scale
How helpful were the emails sent after each group meeting listing important things?	2	5.00	1–5 scale
How helpful were the group practice sessions for running participants?	2	5.00	1–5 scale
How helpful were the individual practice sessions for running participants?	2	5.00	1–5 scale
How clearly were the communications between Skylar and RAs?	2	5.00	1–5 scale
How do you feel about the amount of email communication?	2	3.50	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

What did you learn from this experience?

Response 1. How experiments are run and how to follow protocols

Response 2. i learned that there is also that goes into research gathering and if one thing goes wrong then the whole thing could collapse

What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience?

Response 1. nothing I can think of

Do you have any suggestions for the study sessions (running participants)?

Response 1. no

What should Skylar keep doing when working with future undergraduate RAs?

Response 1. the meetings and practice sessions were very helpful

Response 2. Everything the same!!! love her

What should Skylar improve when working with future undergraduate RAs?

Response 1. nothing I can think of

Response 2. more practice with running the experiment

Do you have any other suggestions/opinions?

Response 1. not at the moment

Fall 2022

PhD program; midsemester evaluation. Research assistants mentored: 9. Completed evaluations: 6 (66.7% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Overall research experience	4.83
Experience met expectations	5.00

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
How useful are the weekly group meetings?	5	4.00	1–5 scale
How useful are the assigned articles/podcast episodes?	5	4.20	1–5 scale
How useful are the article discussion?	5	4.00	1–5 scale
How useful are the presentations?	5	3.80	1–5 scale
How is your experience with Slack communication?	6	5.00	1–5 scale
How clearly were the communications between Skylar and RAs?	6	5.00	1–5 scale
How do you feel about the amount of communication?	6	3.33	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

Have you been able to attend the group meetings?

Response 1. Yes

Response 2. Yes

Response 3. No

Response 4. Yes

Response 5. Yes

Response 6. Yes

Do you have any suggestions for the group meeting?

Response 1. not at this moment

Response 5. No, I really like the way they are now

Do you have any suggestions to improve our communication?

Response 1. not at the moment

Response 5. No, it's very effective

What did you learn from this experience?

Response 1. I learned how to communicate with participants and collect data

Response 2. I learned first hand about the research process and how studies are performed. I find this particularly helpful because I'm currently enrolled in PSY250, which has an emphasis on research and design. I find the combination of class work and hands on experience to be particularly helpful as a psychology student.

Response 3. This has been my first RA position so everything that I have been learning is brand new to me!

Response 4. I have learned more about research design, how to eliminate alternative explanations, the process of getting a study approved, and how to more effectively do a literature review.

Response 5. The application of everything I've learned in the classroom I now get to do in person

Response 6. Communication, working with others, and following instructions along with many other things

What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience?

Response 1. I hoped to learn more about the study writing process

Response 2. I have learned a lot from this experience and there is nothing I believe I'm missing.

Response 4. I just wanted to gain hands-on experience in a research setting, and all the takeaways have been bonuses to that.

Response 5. Learning how the data is analyzed

Response 6. -

Do you have any suggestions for the study sessions (running participants) specifically?

Response 1. not at the moment it seems pretty efficient

Response 5. no

What is working to facilitate learning/doing research?

Response 1. the meetings help as well as detailed instructions in the RA packet

Response 2. I feel as if the methods of research are very effective given the topic. The game of Tetris beforehand is a nice touch, and is especially helpful as a warm-up before survey 2.

Response 3. The flexibility and method that we have in scheduling! I also think that the additional articles and resources sent really do add quite a bit of information and knowledge.

Response 4. I think the weekly meetings are helping everyone learn why we are doing certain aspects in our study, and how to more effectively run participants. This has also helped me learn how to create studies of my own in the future.

Response 5. The Sharepoint organization is great!

Response 6. Excellent communication, slack

What is impeding learning/doing researching?

Response 1. nothing

Response 2. I don't see anything that impedes research, besides the week where Clark was experiencing maintenance, but that is entirely situational.

Response 3. N/A

Response 4. The one thing that may be impeding learning is not being able to see the behind-the-scenes data analysis or how every survey/measure will be used in the final paper. Getting those insights could maybe help RAs have a better understanding of their purpose.

Response 5. It was the poor laptop internet connection but that's been fixed

Response 6. N/A

Is there anything Skylar can do to improve your experience?

Response 1. not that I can think of

Response 2. Skylar is doing an excellent job running this study. There is nothing I feel that could be improved. Skylar is extremely organized and an excellent communicator. There has not been a time where I've been confused regarding any aspects of the study or scheduling of meetings. I especially appreciate her flexibility in regards to working with my busy schedule.

Response 3. No! She is amazing

Response 5. No, she's great!!

Do you have any additional suggestions?

Response 1. not at the moment

Response 3. I think that a lot of the participants really liked the interview rather than surveys, but I know there's only so much we can ask them verbally that they would truthfully answer other than what we already have.

Response 5. no

Spring 2023

PhD program. Research assistants mentored: 12. Completed evaluations: 8 (66.7% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Overall research experience	4.38
Experience met expectations	4.50

Activity ratings

Scale: 0–10 legacy scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
Usefulness — Weekly large group meetings (Wed 3pm) in general	5	8.40	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Weekly reading group meetings (Wed 1pm) in general	5	7.40	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Reading papers relevant to our studies	8	6.88	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Presenting something you are interested in during the 3pm group meeting	5	6.40	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Listening to other RAs presenting during the 3pm group meeting	5	5.20	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Creating a literature review matrix (1pm reading group)	5	7.20	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Mini-lectures by Skylar	7	8.29	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Group article discussion	7	7.71	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — Talking about graduate school applications	8	7.50	0–10 legacy scale
Usefulness — End of the semester one-on-one check-in	7	8.00	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Weekly large group meetings (Wed 3pm) in general	5	8.00	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Weekly reading group meetings (Wed 1pm) in general	5	6.80	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Reading papers relevant to our studies	8	6.50	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Presenting something you are interested in during the 3pm group meeting	5	6.40	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Listening to other RAs presenting during the 3pm group meeting	5	6.00	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Creating a literature review matrix (1pm reading group)	5	6.60	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Mini-lectures by Skylar	8	6.38	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Group article discussion	8	7.25	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — Talking about graduate school applications	8	7.38	0–10 legacy scale
Enjoyment — End of the semester one-on-one check-in	7	7.71	0–10 legacy scale

Anonymous written responses

Do you have any suggestions for the group meeting?

Response 4. No

Response 7. No

Do you have any suggestions to improve our communication?

Response 4. No

What did you learn from this experience? *

Response 1. I learned how to run participants in a study as well as how to apply previous research to new research

Response 2. While this was a great experience, I know I don't want to go into research :(

Response 3. I learned I don't love research

Response 4. How to work with participants to collect data and learn how to improve our study by reading similar studies

Response 5. I was happy that I got the chance to learn and complete emails/communications with participants

Response 6. I learned how to create a literature matrix, which will be beneficial with future research I do. I also learned more about the behind-the-scenes of research designs, writing, and analysis

Response 7. General practice in a study environment

Response 8. I learned a lot about the research process and what is important for me to focus on for my goal moving forward

What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience?

Response 2. N/a

Response 4. I think it would be interesting to look at the data at the end of the semester

Response 5. writing but I think I'll get that in the future

Response 6. I got everything I expected out of this experience

Response 7. More about workstations

Do you have any suggestions for the study sessions (running participants) specifically?

Response 3. Bring homework/something to do

Response 4. I think it would be interesting to bring participants back to try the other two conditions they didn't do the first time

Response 5. no

Response 7. No

What is working to facilitate learning/doing research?

Response 1. I appreciate all of the support we get

Response 4. Weekly meetings

Response 5. an extensive and collaborative process to study specific phenomenon in controlled environments

Response 6. The weekly meetings are very beneficial to help us find topics we are interested in and apply them to what we are researching in the lab.

Response 7. The detailed variables being recorded

What is impeding learning/doing researching?

Response 4. Nothing

Response 5. miscommunication, funding/resources(haha)

Response 7. Sometimes participants barely notice the desk is adjustable if it is already at a good height

Is there anything Skylar can do to improve your experience?

Response 3. Skylar was great

Response 4. Nope :)

Response 5. no

Response 7. Na

Do you have any additional suggestions?

Response 4. No

Response 5. no

Fall 2023

PhD program. Research assistants mentored: 8. Completed evaluations: 7 (87.5% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Mentor knowledgeable	5.00
Mentor enthusiastic	5.00
Mentor prepared	5.00
Experiment-session instructions clear	4.86
Overall mentor rating	5.00
Overall research experience	5.00
Experience met expectations	5.00

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
Weekly meeting in general	7	4.43	1–5 scale
Article discussion	7	4.29	1–5 scale
Present a proposed study of your interest	5	4.40	1–5 scale
Listening to other people's presentations	7	4.71	1–5 scale
Mini-lectures by the research mentor	7	4.71	1–5 scale
Research mentor answering questions about graduate school	7	5.00	1–5 scale
Practice protocols with other RA(s)	6	4.33	1–5 scale
Weekly check-in of the shift schedule	6	4.83	1–5 scale
Lead RA Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	5	5.00	1–5 scale
Evaluator Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	4	5.00	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

What is your overall feelings/comments about your research experience this semester and interaction with your research mentor?

Response 1. I found my research experience to be really helpful and informative.

Response 2. I really enjoyed it and can't wait for next semester!

Response 3. Skylar was very prepared and well informed. It was a great experience overall and I wish I had more time to dedicate to working with Skylar

Response 4. Great! Skylar- you're so thoughtful and I feel lucky to work with you! I get to learn and create so many new experiences with you/the lab.

Response 5. It was great

Response 6. I had a lot of fun being a part of the study, and I'm so grateful for the opportunity. Skylar was a fantastic mentor, she made everything clear and easy to do.

Response 7. Overall, I absolutely loved this experience. I've learned so much from Skylar and offers incredible support and feedback. Her genuine interest in the research is infectious and makes me want to pursue academia.

What have you learned? What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience, if any?

Response 1. I've learned more in depth about the research experience

Response 2. I learned about several steps in the research process that I wouldn't have learned in class. There is nothing I didn't learn that I wish I had.

Response 3. I learned a lot about the research process.

Response 4. How to do a good literature search, communicating with participants, writing protocols, etc. I think I'd love to start learning more within the manuscript writing side and the data side.

Response 5. I have learned a lot of new techniques

Response 6. I learned a lot about research in general and how to conduct research as well as how to figure out what sorts of things I'm most interested in.

Response 7. I had no expectations about what I would learned. So I learned a lot, about how to setup, collect, and run a study. I learned about the constant reading of relevant literature and the continuous tweaking of the study to ensure we are measuring what we want to measure. I just learned what is like to be a researcher in psychology!

Do you have any suggestions for either the weekly meeting or the experiment sessions in future semesters?

Response 2. Members choose articles that we discuss.

Response 4. N/A

Response 6. Nope!

Response 7. Not at the moment!

Is there anything else you would like your research mentor or their supervisor to know?

Response 2. Thank you for a fantastic semester!

Response 4. N/A

Response 6. No, but thank you so much for the opportunity. It's been so much fun and I'm so excited I got to be a part of this.

Response 7. Skylar was an incredible mentor and I'm so happy that I chose to apply to this lab!

Spring 2024

PhD program. Research assistants mentored: 12. Completed evaluations: 10 (83.3% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Mentor knowledgeable	5.00
Mentor enthusiastic	4.80
Mentor prepared	4.90
Experiment-session instructions clear	4.40
Overall mentor rating	5.00
Overall research experience	5.00
Experience met expectations	4.80

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
Weekly meeting in general	9	4.56	1–5 scale
Article discussion	10	4.30	1–5 scale
Present a proposed study of your interest	8	4.12	1–5 scale
Listening to other people's presentations	9	4.33	1–5 scale
Mini-lectures by the research mentor	10	4.80	1–5 scale
Research mentor answering questions about graduate school	10	4.80	1–5 scale
Lead RA Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	7	5.00	1–5 scale
Evaluator Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	8	4.62	1–5 scale
End-of-semester one-on-one check in meeting	10	4.70	1–5 scale
Discussing Error Tight	8	4.38	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

What is your overall feelings/comments about your research experience this semester and interaction with your research mentor?

- Response 1.** I really enjoyed my research experience this semester. It was a great experience and I feel very grateful that I was able to be a part of the team. I was extremely impressed with my research mentor and their knowledge about the study and the overall research process. I feel as if I learned a lot this semester and much of that is due to my research mentor.
- Response 2.** I loved everyone I worked with although the research didn't end up being my particular area of interest
- Response 3.** It was a good introduction to research and getting a good grasp of how research is conducted
- Response 4.** I had a really great time. The group was really fun this semester especially since we were able to have everyone in there at the same time. It was a really fun process
- Response 5.** It was great! Communication was awesome and everyone was very helpful with each other
- Response 6.** I really enjoyed this semester and feel like I gained a lot of great experience as a researcher and student.
- Response 7.** I enjoyed it. I think Skylar and I interacted well, and it was fun being the only non-Skylar grad student.
- Response 8.** The evaluator experience is nice but the Lead RA experience is invaluable due to the higher position demand
- Response 9.** It was very positive for the short amount of time I was involved for.
- Response 10.** The lab experience gets better with time! I have gained a better sense of research as a whole the longer I am part of this lab which is so useful for graduate school!

What have you learned? What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience, if any?

- Response 1.** I learned a lot about the research process, what leading a team of undergrad students looks like, study design, areas of research, and how to present/talk about what you're conducting research on, and best practices in research and design.
- Response 2.** I've learned about the research process, how to read academic papers, and how study proposals work.

Response 3. I have learned a lot about how TSST works as a stress measurement task and on how to better read and understand research papers

Response 4. I learned a lot about how to do literature reviews, what it takes to put a study together, and just more about this topic which I may not have known had I not had the opportunity to be part of the lab.

Response 5. I learned so much, I didn't have a ton of expectations but I learned how to properly administer research sessions, identify deviations, collect data, work collaboratively with evaluators and Lead RAs alike,, the research process

Response 6. I learned a lot more than I expected to. For me, the most important thing I learned was how to write an abstract and do a poster presentation.

Response 7. I learned how to have a "lab presence" and turn on researcher mode. I did not come into the lab with any preconceived expectations, so there were no disappointments on that front. It was cool to hear what psych students were learning in their classes.

Response 8. I learned how important the protocol is for maintaining internal validity

Response 9. It was my first research position, so I learned a lot about the research process, how to work with participants, the intricate inner workings of research designs, etc.

Response 10. This semester I learned more about the organizational role research requires to effectively run a team in research

Do you have any suggestions for either the weekly meeting or the experiment sessions in future semesters? It can be anything from how to better conduct the training to alternative activities within the group. Any idea is appreciated!

Response 1. In the future, when students are presenting their presentation I think that they should have to connect it to their article so that way everyone comes into the discussion with some base knowledge on the subject matter. This way there will be more informed discussion about the area of study!

Response 2. All I think is that more training would be beneficial.

Response 3. Having more mock training sessions I'd feel would be useful

Response 4. I think it would be helpful to talk about what the different readings in the elite HRV app mean. I also think it could be helpful to do the error tight stuff at the beginning of the semester and the getting to know the team activities.

Response 5. I think overall it was great, but maybe some more binding activities in the beginning?

Response 6. I don't have any suggestions - I like how we get to choose our own article/podcast to present on.

Response 7. Discussed with Skylar in 1:1

Response 8. Not a suggestion but a comment, I don't see how the proposed studies really matter if you're an undergraduate student who isn't going into the research field.

Response 10. N/A... more podcasts? (Could RAs suggest podcasts?)

Is there anything else you would like your research mentor or their supervisor to know?

Response 1. Thank you for the wonderful opportunity to be in the lab, I greatly enjoyed my experience and I'll keep my eye peeled for its publication!

Response 3. Thank you for all the advice and mentorship

Response 4. Thank you for giving me the opportunity to work with you guys. I'm extremely grateful and have had nothing short of an amazing experience in this lab.

Response 5. I had a great semester!!

Response 6. Nope

Response 7. I enjoyed my time! Thanks for having me, and for helping me!

Response 8. N/A

Response 10. This lab is so helpful for students to gain research skills & mentorship! It's truly an honor to be part of this lab!

Fall 2024

PhD program. Research assistants mentored: 14. Completed evaluations: 10 (71.4% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Mentor knowledgeable	4.90
Mentor enthusiastic	4.90
Experiment-session instructions clear	4.56
Overall mentor rating	4.80
Overall research experience	4.80
Experience met expectations	4.70

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
Weekly meeting in general	9	3.78	1–5 scale
Making infographics on past research articles	9	3.44	1–5 scale
Listening to other people's presentations	9	3.78	1–5 scale
Mini-lectures by the research mentor (e.g., statistical model explanation, new study design, pilot data analysis)	9	4.78	1–5 scale
Lead RA Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	8	4.62	1–5 scale
Evaluator Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	9	4.56	1–5 scale
End-of-semester one-on-one check in meeting	8	4.25	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

What is your overall feelings/comments about your research experience this semester and interaction with your research mentor?

- Response 1.** Overall I felt like this experience was very positive and I was able to learn a lot from Skylar
- Response 2.** I thought my research mentor was great and super helpful integrating me into the research so late into the study. I enjoyed the research experience overall!
- Response 3.** Skylar was very passionate about research and the project, which in someway also heightened my interest into the ergonomic aspect in workplace. Overall, my research experience was exceptional, and Skylar was very helpful in the process.
- Response 4.** Loved working with them
- Response 5.** As a post-bac RA, the expectation and experience is different than being an undergrad RA. I have felt extremely fortunate to be able to work with and gain more research experience while continuing with the lab and research mentor, Skylar!
- Response 6.** Very helpful and learned a lot!
- Response 7.** I felt like I learned a lot!
- Response 8.** I really enjoyed the experience this semester! I feel like I got to take on a lot more responsibilities and different roles I've never had before, which was exciting and so beneficial for me and my goals.
- Response 9.** My experience was good until I think I truly realized a lack of communication occurring.
- Response 10.** I had a great experience that allowed me to learn a lot. My research mentor was very helpful and knowledgeable about the research that we are doing. She was also very supportive and helpful in a lot of situations.

What have you learned? What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience, if any?

- Response 1.** I learned a lot about the research process, the importance of double checking, how to communicate as a team, and how to condense information from an article into something more palatable for a general audience
- Response 2.** I learned more about all of the processes that occur in order to plan a study and implement it.
- Response 3.** I learned the process of a basic research, from designing, to collecting pilot data, to analyzing, then community data, final analyzing, and paper writing. I hope to learn more about the different types of research method that was not covered from this experience.
- Response 4.** Learned a lot more than my previous experience. From experimental procedures, research, participant recruitment, I learned quite a lot

Response 5. I learned more about the steps to create a manuscript and how to balance the multiple hats that a researcher wears.

Response 6. Learned how to be an RA, learned a lot more about the research process in depth

Response 7. It was nice to understand what the environment in a psychology lab is like

Response 8. I learned more about leadership, collaborating on new projects, creating infographics, working as a project manager, and participant recruitment.

Response 9. I learned a ton about how research works, including the process in which you create a protocol, test it, etc.

Response 10. I have learned how to deal with problems quickly and professionally. I've learned more about how the research design process begins and all the ways in which we can gather data from various aspects and measures in a study.

Do you have any suggestions for either the weekly meeting or the experiment sessions in future semesters? It can be anything from how to better conduct the training to alternative activities within the group. Any idea is appreciated!

Response 1. I like the current structure of the meetings, I liked learning about the statistical methods and I wish I learned more!

Response 2. NA

Response 3. I think the weekly meeting can be changed to virtual meeting if finding a meeting time where everyone is available is an issue. This way the remote RA can also join, and everyone can have the opportunity to know each other more and community better.

Response 4. Have feedback written out for the infographics

Response 5. N/A

Response 8. I would love to talk more about the HRV app and what all of the readings mean during weekly meetings, I'd also love to continue the research presentations along with creating infographics.

Response 9. I think the weekly meetings are cool, helps connect the different members of the lab! But, rarely anyone showed so it was hard to have that bond without them there, or they went on a different day.

Response 10. I know that the weekly meetings were conducted differently than in previous semesters due to different circumstances. Next semester I'd like to have more mini lectures because I found them very interesting and learned a lot from them. I didn't find the infographics very helpful but I did appreciate hearing other people's presentations.

Is there anything else you would like your research mentor or their supervisor to know?

Response 1. I have greatly appreciated this experience!

Response 2. I have really enjoyed my time as a URA so far!

Response 3. I love you both. <3 Thanks for a wonderful semester, Merry Christmas to you and your family.

Response 5. Thank you for everything you do! Your consideration and hard work do not go unnoticed!

Response 8. Thank you for your mentorship and I look forward to working again here soon!

Response 10. No, I think that everything went very smoothly and I am very happy with my experience.

Spring 2025

PhD program. Research assistants mentored: 18. Completed evaluations: 11 (61.1% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Mentor knowledgeable	5.00
Mentor enthusiastic	5.00
Experiment-session instructions clear	4.73
Overall mentor rating	4.82
Overall research experience	4.82
Experience met expectations	4.64

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
Weekly meeting in general	9	4.11	1–5 scale
Creating and presenting your research proposal/literature review	9	3.89	1–5 scale
Listening to other people's presentations	9	3.67	1–5 scale
Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	9	4.67	1–5 scale
Deviation discussion	9	4.44	1–5 scale
R Coding Session	6	4.17	1–5 scale
Early semester IDP meeting	9	3.78	1–5 scale
End-of-semester one-on-one check in meeting	11	4.18	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

What is your overall feelings/comments about your research experience this semester and interaction with your research mentor?

Response 1. I really really enjoyed it even though it is not in my career path to be in research.

Response 2. I really enjoyed my time as a RA this semester. I feel like everyone got along and supported eachother when needed. The instructions were pretty clear for this semester and everything was organized which was helpful.

Response 3. It's been an extremely rewarding process and I've learned so much from Skylar.

Response 4. Great experience this semester

Response 5. I had a great time in the lab. It was an amazing opportunity and really gained a lot of wisdom from it.

Response 6. I thought this experience was harder than I expected, but really educational and engaging my mentor was very helpful

Response 7. It was ok, just wish I had done more on my end. Skylar was a great mentor through it all

Response 8. I really enjoyed the process of research, and I loved working with all the different RA's. It was definitely different, but a good start to my research experience.

Response 9. I think Skylar was really helpful in the learning process, and the communication of ideas were thorough and clear.

Response 10. Positive!

Response 11. This semester was really great. The team is very supportive and kind, as well as Skylar.

What have you learned? What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience, if any?

Response 1. I have learned how studies are conducted, how data is collected, how communication in the research field is conducted

Response 2. I learned how to do a research proposal, more about r coding, and conducting and collecting data from experiments.

Response 3. I learned a lot about protocol design, more about running experiments, how to design my own research, how to take the lead in identifying the literature gaps and necessary information for running an experiment, etc.

Response 4. I learned a lot in general about TSST and the research process.

Response 5. I learned about the real side of research. They talk a lot about it, so seeing and participating in it first hand is great experience.

Response 6. I learned a lot about working with participants and the process of conducting research. There are lots of little details to pay attention too

Response 7. I've learned a lot of research skills like data management and protocol designs. I liked the hands on experience with everything compared to my previous experience which was remote

Response 8. I learned a lot about protocols, and different variables that can be changed. The only thing I didn't learn much about is the data evaluation that is going to take place and what specifically is going to be looked at.

Response 9. I learned the process of research from designing to data analysis, the specific information that we have to pay attention to in the process. I hope to learn more about the analysis part, and which analysis tool to use for the methodology.

Response 10. Getting better at time management, writing, and planning!

Response 11. I've learned more about how to adapt to a new protocol and how to communicate with my team.

Do you have any suggestions for either the weekly meeting, the one-on-one meetings, or the experiment sessions in future semesters? It can be anything from how to better conduct the training to alternative activities within the group. Any idea is appreciated!

Response 1. N/A

Response 2. Nope!

Response 3. No. I think the way we did it this semester was really helpful, I really liked that we went over HRV and TSST in our readings, I think that was helpful for everyone in understanding why we use those measures.

Response 4. No!

Response 5. No i think continuing the one on one is good as it builds connections.

Response 6. I enjoyed it as it is.

Response 7. Please no more IDP

Response 8. Training with multiple different lead RAs would be helpful.

Response 9. No

Response 10. N/A

Response 11. Nothing comes to mind!

Is there anything else you would like your research mentor or their supervisor to know?

Response 1. Nope, thank you for everything!

Response 2. Thank you for a great couple semesters, I really enjoyed my time here and learned a lot!

Response 3. Just thank you for taking me under your wing and helping me with everything. I've learned so much about psychology and research and just overall life from learning under Skylar.

Response 4. I had a great semester!

Response 5. I really had a great time, and thank you for the opportunity to participate!

Response 6. I really appreciated all the support you gave me and how much I learned while i was here.

Response 7. Na

Response 8. n/a

Response 9. I love you guys.

Response 10. I'm so grateful for how flexible post-bac RA-ing has been. Thank you!

Response 11. Nope!

Spring 2026

PhD program. Research assistants mentored: 16. Completed evaluations: 7 (43.8% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Mentor knowledgeable	5.00
Mentor enthusiastic	5.00
Experiment-session instructions clear	4.71
Overall mentor rating	5.00
Overall research experience	4.57
Experience met expectations	4.57

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
Weekly meeting in general	7	4.29	1–5 scale
Creating and presenting your research proposal	6	4.17	1–5 scale
Listening to other people's presentations	7	3.86	1–5 scale
Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	6	4.83	1–5 scale
Deviation discussion	6	4.50	1–5 scale
Activity on the career kills (google form)	7	4.29	1–5 scale
Reading articles in the field	7	4.29	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

What is your overall feelings/comments about your research experience this semester and interaction with your research mentor?

Response 1. I had a great time and learned a lot

Response 2. I really enjoyed my experience this semester!

Response 3. I think that this semester went much better than last. I really enjoyed that I got a lot closer with other RAs this semester and Skylar as well. I felt like once we had training done, showing up to lab wasn't as much of a task and I felt productive when I would leave a lab session.

Response 4. I thought this was an awesome introduction to the world of structured academic research. Skylar was extremely passionate about her field and helpful in explaining concepts that I didn't understand. She was also very good about acknowledging that we are humans who experience ups and downs, and accommodated when necessary.

Response 5. Overall, I thought this was a very good experience, and I have learned a lot that I will use later in my career.

Response 6. I have enjoyed this year a lot and I feel like I improved a lot of aspects of my soft and hard skills.

Response 7. I have learned so much being in this lab. I felt like I was able to grow a lot personally and academically. The article presentations allowed me to practice my public speaking skills and answering questions on the spot used to be an uncomfortable task for me but now I feel more at ease doing so. Skylar has been very patient and helpful throughout my whole experience as an RA and I am so grateful for this experience. I have never taken a research class or anything beyond Psych 100 so I have taken away a lot of information from the field of psychology in this lab and am very proud to be part of it.

What have you learned? What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience, if any?

Response 1. I learned a wide range of skills in all areas of research and lab settings

Response 2. I learned a lot about the research process and literature.

Response 3. I have learned that I love working with other people and especially people from the community when we would work with participants as a lead RA. I wish I learned a little bit more about the science behind our research and some of the findings (which I know is tough because we haven't done any data analysis yet).

Response 4. I learned a lot about study design, research methods, and the importance of monitoring biases throughout research.

Response 5. I learned what a structured research lab looks like, the duties I would be doing, and the overall process. I would like to learn more about behind the scenes, but I think those sort of opportunities will come later.

Response 6. I have learned a lot about stress in general and how it affects people. I also learned a lot about how to efficiently read an academic article.

Response 7. I have learned about how research is conducted, how to resent research, how to trouble shoot and how to effectively run a research lab.

What did you do well this semester, and what you think you could have done better?

Response 1. I could have done better with checking my protocol.

Response 2. I think I did well attendance-wise, but I could have done better with some of the at home work.

Response 3. I think this semester I did much better with timely communication and time management. I think one thing I could have done better was put more effort into learning material such as the readings and the research proposals.

Response 4. I did a good job of handling logistics, though I could've been better about handling independent projects.

Response 5. I think I did very well at problem-solving when things came up, especially during lab sessions with real participants. I could've done better at some of the readings. I would've liked to read more in-depth and really understand the literature.

Response 6. I think I did well asking questions and participating in group discussions. I think I could have does better with my proposal mostly just tinkering through my research question before submitting it because as I was doing it, I realized I did not really like my research idea.

Response 7. I think I came to every lab meeting prepared to participate as much as possible in the discussion and I think I could have done better with my research proposal and asked for more guidance with that.

Do you have any suggestions for either the weekly meeting or the experiment sessions in future semesters? It can be anything from how to better conduct the training to alternative activities within the group. Any idea is appreciated!

Response 1. No I think it was great!

Response 2. Sometimes the workload can be a lot, as I spend more time with all the workload in the lab than any of my classes.

Response 4. None!

Response 5. I think maybe for one of the meetings you could incorporate, if possible, a day where we look at the past data we have found and analyse what we can learn from it as a group, in order to expose us to what that can look like.

Response 6. I like the walk and talks keep doing those!

Is there anything else you would like your research mentor or their supervisor to know?

Response 1. Im very thankful for the opportunity this lab gave me

Response 2. I really enjoyed how thorough and how much time Skylar puts into the lab to make sure things are being ran smoothly and we are all learning from it.

Response 4. Nope!

Response 5. n/a

Response 6. No :)

Summer 2026

PhD program. Research assistants mentored: 10. Completed evaluations: 6 (60.0% approximate coverage).

Comparable 1-5 ratings

Means are shown for items included in this period's instrument. Blank or omitted items were not collected.

Evaluation item	Mean
Mentor knowledgeable	5.00
Mentor enthusiastic	4.83
Experiment-session instructions clear	5.00
Overall mentor rating	5.00
Overall research experience	4.83
Experience met expectations	5.00

Activity ratings

Scale: 1–5 scale. Response counts vary when respondents did not participate or selected not applicable.

Activity	N	Mean	Scale
Weekly meeting in general	6	4.83	1–5 scale
Creating and presenting your research proposal	6	4.83	1–5 scale
Listening to other people's presentations	6	5.00	1–5 scale
Check-in and check-out forms for study sessions	6	5.00	1–5 scale
Deviation discussion	6	4.83	1–5 scale
Reading articles in the field	6	4.83	1–5 scale

Anonymous written responses

What is your overall feelings/comments about your research experience this semester and interaction with your research mentor?

Response 1. I honestly don't have anything negative to say. This research experience exceeded my expectations. I went into this just thinking it would be something nice to throw onto my resume while giving me the chance to study a topic I'd never really put much consideration into. Now, I feel like I've learned so much about research as a whole and the topic of active workstations, and I truly had a good time with running the experiments, interacting with fellow RAs, and working with and hearing new ideas from Skylar. It has genuinely been such a pleasure to be a part of this study!

Response 2. Super meaningful experience and learned a lot from my mentor about academic research

Response 3. Being a part of this research team was a very good beginner experience, because the instructions were very thorough and clear, and there was a lot of grace for mistakes.

Response 4. Overall very positive experience that has added a lot to my experience with research and development in my time as a student. The mentors were super supportive and knowledgeable, they might've just needed a clearer rubric on what prospective RAs were going to be tested on.

Response 5. I had an amazing time. I come out of each semester working under Skylar feeling smarter and more prepared for my future working in a lab.

Response 6. I have very positive feelings towards my experience this semester and my interactions with my research mentor. I found all of the resources to be very helpful and they made the experience very "friendly" and I appreciated a lot of the support my research mentor gave me when designing my own experiment at the end of the period.

What have you learned? What did you hope to learn but did not learn from this experience, if any?

Response 1. Like I said, I came into this with very little knowledge about active workstations. Though I don't know everything, I see how beneficial they can be and how they help people (specifically office workers) in different ways. Having been a research participant in the past, I know also know what it's like to work behind the scenes in running experiments and all the clean up that comes after.

Response 2. Gained a lot hands on experience in conducting experiment sessions and especially in important skills of being in a research team

Response 3. I learned a lot about the research process and got to experience the ins and outs first hand. I had hoped to learn more about the analysis process but I know that that is beyond the scopes of the position we were expected to do.

Response 4. I learned a lot about how to interview participants, how detailed protocols should be, what a protocol can look like, what an effective research team looks like (having participant logs, SSS, meetings, etc.), and how to be an evaluator for a TSST. I don't think there was anything else I wanted to learn that was not addressed.

Response 5. I learned how to work effectively with participants and how to think on my feet when there are unexpected snags. I also learned how to put together effective proposal presentations and input data correctly. Everything I wanted to learn was taught and then some.

Response 6. I learned a lot about experimental design and the importance of measuring exactly what you want/need to from this experience. In my classes we go over this, but I found it very helpful to see the implementation in an actual experimental design. I also learned a lot about different types of measurements and when and how each of them can be practically used to measure a larger concept.

What did you do well this semester, and what you think you could have done better?

Response 1. I think I did really well in working by myself to solve issues. Being a part of an ongoing experiment and noticing something wrong was definitely nerve-racking at first, but I think I handled all those times well, especially as the summer went on. I think I could have been better in time management, particularly with transcript cleaning. This is something I know I have to improve in my school assignments too, but with working in a lab, it feels more “important” (just my personal mindset) so I find myself being more disappointed when I do procrastinate.

Response 2. Experience through the entire process of data collection and built up relevant skills. I think if I am running experiment sessions next time, I will be more mindful in reflecting the research aim and minimizing the deviations

Response 3. I think I did well on communicating and learning from mistakes. I think I could have been better about slowing down and making sure I was very carefully following ALL instructions, which was the biggest struggle of mine during the quality checks.

Response 4. I think I did well at staying consistent with my interviewing process and communicating any questions or mishaps I had. I could've been better about bringing the same amount of energy to each lab visit, this varied based on my work and everything else.

Response 5. I think I could have done better with reading the schedule and keeping track of the various responsibilities I had. There were a couple of times this semester where I didn't realize I had a training shift or wrote down the wrong time for a room reservation or Zoom meeting. Thankfully I try and double-check everything, so nothing turned into a problem.

Response 6. I think I did well with minimizing any deviations during the session set up and throughout the script. I did struggle sometimes with anticipating how participants were going to respond in the interview, which resulted in a couple of possibly leading questions or comments on my part.

Do you have any suggestions for either the weekly meeting or the experiment sessions in future semesters? It can be anything from how to better conduct the training to alternative activities within the group. Any idea is appreciated!

Response 1. The only thing I can really think of is a way for us RAs to get to know each other better, especially in the beginning. Over time, I did find myself becoming close with a couple of people I had several evaluators shifts with, but that was really it. I think if we knew each other better on a more personal level, we could work together even better than we already were. Honestly though, this isn't that big of a deal by the end of the experiment, but it was hard in the beginning.

Response 2. n/a

Response 3. I think things were very well formatted, I can't think of anything I would change.

Response 4. I think like I said previously, when training new RAs, just have a better rubric and layout of exact expectations before the quality check.

Response 5. The weekly meetings were very helpful, and I appreciated the articles that we read. For me personally, going over everyone's weekly deviations was extremely beneficial. There were many times when I ended up running into the same problem as someone else in my group and was able to know the correct way forward because we had discussed it in our meeting.

Response 6. I can't think of anything off of the top of my head, other than maybe having "brush-up" training sessions throughout the time period. After getting used to giving a specific type of lab-visit, the protocol for the other one felt a bit rusty, so practicing that again might have been useful.

Is there anything else you would like your research mentor or their supervisor to know?

Response 1. I cannot express my gratitude and enjoyment enough. This has been a wonderful experience and I loved working with everyone at the lab. Thank you so much for trusting me to be a part of this!!

Response 2. n/a

Response 3. Not at this time.

Response 4. N/A

Response 5. I greatly admire Skylar's talent with leading a group and her ability to schedule/organize/communicate. She showed me how I should aim to conduct myself not only in a career with lab work but also in professional spaces as a whole.

Evaluation record

This document contains the complete anonymized quantitative summaries and written responses currently compiled for the nine evaluation periods listed above. Names, IP addresses, response IDs, email fields, timestamps, and other administrative metadata are excluded.